

Speaker: [00:00:02] For those who don't know. It's improved.

Interviewer: [00:00:19] It has improved so much, really so much, that before I even start the interview, I want to show you the consent form. You'll see that it includes confidential data and such. I'll also send it by email because there's space for responses. You can fill it out and email it back if you prefer. Or you can verbally consent during the interview now and then send it by email later so we don't spend too much time here. But it's up to you.

Speaker: [00:00:48] That's fine, no problem.

Interviewer: [00:00:50] So I'll share the screen and email it simultaneously. If you could put your email in the chat, I'll send it right away.

Speaker: [00:01:00] In the team chat or [Social Media]?

Interviewer: [00:01:04] Whichever is convenient for you.

Interviewer: [00:01:18] This argument between...

Interviewer: [00:01:30] I've sent it. Can you confirm if you received it?

Speaker: [00:01:50] No, not yet.

Interviewer: [00:01:59] I think it should arrive soon. It might be due to a lot of people receiving it simultaneously.

Interviewer: [00:02:10] In the end, I'll ask again. Since we're on the record, I'll read it quickly because I need to do this. This is so you know more quickly. We're conducting an exploratory study called A Multicultural Investigation into the Conceptualization and Measurement of Relationship Quality, which aims to understand what [Nationality] consider to be a good relationship. We want to study the concept of relationship quality. During the interview, if you have any questions about what quality means, please ask because that's exactly what we're seeking through this interview. We believe you can provide valuable insights for our research, and we'd like to invite you to an interview. This interview can be conducted in person or online, in this case online. You will be asked questions about your experiences and perspectives on your current relationship and romantic relationships in general. If you agree to participate, the interview will last around one hour. Participation is completely voluntary, and you can stop the interview at any time if you no longer wish to participate. The results of this research will be shared with the scientific community. However, the information you provide will be anonymous and will not be identified according to the recommendations of resolutions from May 2010 and 510 of 2016 from the National Health Council. After the interview, if you have any questions about the research, you can contact us via email. This is my email and [Name]'s email. He is the professor responsible for the [laboratory]. If you wish to talk to someone not involved in any stage of the interview, this is [Name]'s email. He is a professor from the Philippines conducting

this study in five countries. You'll need to contact him in English. This is the part where you will mark yes or no. I want to know if you consent to us using the interview audio.

Speaker: [00:04:10] Yes, definitely.

Interviewer: [00:04:12] Great. And here, if you agree with how the data will be shared. At the end of the interview, I'll ask you again because as you respond, you might change your mind. We can transcribe differently or not transcribe some parts of the answers. You can respond now, but at the end, I'll ask again. Is that okay?

Speaker: [00:04:34] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:04:38] I'll...

Interviewer: [00:04:40] Another thing, as I mentioned in the email, is about your data. I'm talking mainly about the transcription, which won't be accessed and where we'll publish it, in case you're interested in seeing the research results. Since I sent it to you, I won't read everything.

Speaker: [00:05:03] Did it arrive in the email?

Interviewer: [00:05:06] Thank you! I think that's it. We can start. If you want to respond now, that's fine. Everything is clear.

Speaker: [00:05:18] Let me see. Maybe it's better to respond later. I'm not sure.

Interviewer: [00:05:41] Either way, you've given oral consent. You can respond later after reading it more calmly. Can we start?

Interviewer: [00:05:50] Yes, we can.

Interviewer: [00:05:56] Thank you very much for participating. It's very difficult to find people willing to spend an hour, so it's very important. Thank you very much.

Interviewer: [00:06:05] I'll ask some questions first about your age and some things about you, then about relationships. So, how old are you?

Speaker: [00:06:17] I'm [21-25].

Interviewer: [00:06:19] Looking down because I'm writing the answers. No problem. How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: [00:06:27] [6-10] years.

Interviewer: [00:06:34] Do you have any children? Not necessarily with her.

Speaker: [00:06:37] No, no.

Interviewer: [00:06:39] With whom do you live?

Speaker: [00:06:42] I live with my grandmother.

Interviewer: [00:06:49] What is your main source of income? What is your current profession?

Speaker: [00:06:54] For now, I'm an [Job Title] in [Field], but I'm about to graduate. So, an intern for now. You can put [Job].

Interviewer: [00:07:05] [Job], student, and [6-10] years, right? And how do you want us to refer to your partner? Girlfriend, wife?

Speaker: [00:07:16] Girlfriend.

Interviewer: [00:07:20] So, I'd like you to tell me your love story. How did you meet?

Speaker: [00:07:29] So, we met in [Year]. We attended the same college, [College], and we took some classes together. I studied [Major A] and she studied [Major B]. So, we often ran into each other in the basic courses. I got to know her and started getting closer. I think I initially contacted her on [Social Media], if I'm not mistaken. I got her number, and we started talking more and more each day. It all happened very quickly. It was just a matter of [1-5] weeks. It was a bit crazy, but it was worth it because [1-5] weeks turned into [6-10] years. It was intense, but those [1-5] weeks felt like months of getting to know each other.

Interviewer: [00:08:37] How was the proposal? Did you ask her?

Speaker: [00:08:40] Yes, I did. We were already dating, and one day we went out for dinner. After dinner, I invited her to spend some time at a park. Honestly, I didn't plan to propose that day, but in the moment, I just knew I wanted to, so I asked her to be my girlfriend. We joke that we have our bench in that park where it happened. It was very special.

Interviewer: [00:09:28] And you mentioned the college. Was it in [City A]?

Speaker: [00:09:31] No, it was in [City B].

Interviewer: [00:09:33] Interesting.

Speaker: [00:09:35] Yes, and [Name] studied there too, at [Location].

Interviewer: [00:09:39] Many people from [City A] studied with me in school.

Speaker: [00:09:44] Yes, in high school.

Interviewer: [00:09:47] That's nice. Was the beginning of your relationship very romantic and still is?

Speaker: [00:10:02] Absolutely. She is a year older than me, so when we started dating, I was [16-20] and she was [16-20]. We were both very young, and the beginning was truly romantic and exciting. It still is, but with routine, work, and getting older, things change. We know relationships evolve, and that's normal.

Interviewer: [00:10:41] How do you compare the quality of your relationship to those you've seen among friends or family?

Speaker: [00:12:40] Both of us sometimes wonder if something is wrong because things are so good between us. We rarely argue, and when we do, it's about minor things. We communicate well, and compared to others, we realize we might be more mature. Not to sound superior, but we don't have petty fights. We're good at resolving issues through conversation, which we've seen lacks in many other relationships around us.

Interviewer: [00:13:42] Especially in a culture where machismo and jealousy are common.

Speaker: [00:13:46] Yes, definitely.

Interviewer: [00:13:49] You mentioned the lack of planning in your proposal, which is unconventional.

Speaker: [00:14:06] True. It's unexpected, but it works for us.

Interviewer: [00:14:09] Have you ever had other romantic partners or casual relationships before this?

Speaker: [00:14:20] Yes, but nothing serious.

Interviewer: [00:14:23] Tell me about those.

Speaker: [00:14:23] They were more casual, nothing that compares to my current relationship in terms of communication and maturity.

Interviewer: [00:14:41] So, this relationship stands out in terms of quality.

Speaker: [00:14:49] Yes, definitely. Even my mindset has changed. With her, I think about the future and our plans together.

Interviewer: [00:15:18] What is a high-quality versus low-quality relationship for you?

Speaker: [00:15:30] A low-quality relationship is one where you don't know what to expect, where there are games and unnecessary jealousy, making you insecure. A high-quality relationship is stable, where both partners plan for the future together, communicate well, and support each other's routines and goals.

Interviewer: [00:16:56] Have you ever felt insecure in your relationship?

Speaker: [00:17:03] Not anymore, but in the beginning, I did because she had a past relationship and I didn't. Also, when she went to parties alone, it made me anxious, but we worked through it.

Interviewer: [00:17:53] What's most important in a relationship for you?

Speaker: [00:18:04] Trust and financial organization. These are crucial because financial issues can strain a relationship. It's important to have aligned values and be on the same page about important matters.

Interviewer: [00:19:01] What is love to you?

Speaker: [00:19:13] Love exists in different forms. The love I feel for my mother is different from the love I feel for my girlfriend. It's wanting the best for someone, as much as for yourself. Wanting them to be happy, successful, and healthy.

Interviewer: [00:19:56] How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: [00:20:05] Extremely important, fundamental. Without love, the relationship doesn't make much sense.

Interviewer: [00:20:14] How do you know your girlfriend loves you? What does she do that makes you feel loved?

Speaker: [00:20:25] It's the way she treats me, her words, her physical affection. I'm a person who likes to please, and usually, the way you express love is the way you like to receive it. She knows how to make me feel good, even in small gestures like a massage when I'm tired or making a nice meal.

Interviewer: [00:21:09] It's about making you feel good and cared for.

Speaker: [00:21:15] Exactly. Sometimes it's bringing a glass of water when I'm lying down, or planning something nice for us to do together.

Speaker: [00:21:38] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:21:41] What are the challenges you face in your relationship? You mentioned you rarely argue, but there must be some challenges.

Speaker: [00:21:54] I think, in general, differences in upbringing can be challenging because no one has the same upbringing as someone else. The way you handle things at home, like organization and routine, can differ and cause conflicts.

Interviewer: [00:22:58] Was that a reference to something specific?

Speaker: [00:23:02] Yes, but it's about how people are different in their habits and attitudes.

Interviewer: [00:23:09] What are the challenges you face in your relationship?

Speaker: [00:23:15] Let me think. We have many plans, but sometimes we get discouraged due to financial issues or the length of our relationship. We started dating very young, so it takes time to achieve certain goals, like getting our own place. We just graduated, so we're just starting our financial life.

Interviewer: [00:25:10] Another challenge is the difference in attentiveness. One of you is very attentive, while the other is more relaxed.

Speaker: [00:25:35] Exactly. I'm more attentive to details and punctual, while she's more laid-back, which can sometimes be challenging.

Interviewer: [00:25:47] Yes, that's a good example.

Speaker: [00:25:54] She has allergies to certain foods, which can be challenging because I love those foods but avoid them around her.

Interviewer: [00:26:16] What about household tasks like ironing?

Speaker: [00:26:19] Yes, another example. I'm very organized, almost to a fault, while she's more relaxed about it. We've talked about it and agreed to keep our own sides of the wardrobe to avoid conflicts.

Interviewer: [00:26:33] The difference could be religious, or related to family, or...

Speaker: [00:26:38] Regarding religion, for example, we are both [Religion], but not very practicing. However, she comes from a family that is very devout, attends church every Sunday, and she is a [position]. I wasn't even baptized, and before the relationship, I don't remember the last time I went to church. So, it's not that she forces me, but she encourages me to participate more. It's not a problem, but it can be a bit uncomfortable for me. It's a common divergence. Now, thinking of other things, it's difficult to pinpoint offhand.

Interviewer: [00:27:47] It's indeed difficult to think of examples on the spot, but many couples find it hard. For instance, if one doesn't like spicy food and the other does, it could be something like that.

Speaker: [00:27:58] For example, she has some allergies, which is not exactly an annoyance but can be challenging. She is allergic to shrimp, and I love shrimp, acarajé, and so on. She also can't have peanuts. So, I avoid eating these things around her because I don't want to make her feel bad. These are the situations we navigate.

Interviewer: [00:28:44] Another example could be about ironing clothes. Do you both agree on how to do it?

Speaker: [00:28:50] No, and this brings up another point about our differences in terms of organization. My wardrobe is meticulously organized, almost to a fault. I have a bit of OCD, so everything has its place. She, on the other hand, washes clothes and throws them into the wardrobe. She only irons them when she needs to wear them. We've discussed this because I've told her it could bother me. We've agreed to keep our own sides of the wardrobe to avoid conflicts.

Interviewer: [00:29:51] Right.

Speaker: [00:29:53] The organization issue is something we need to...

Interviewer: [00:29:59] What about going out? Is one of you more of a party-goer while the other is not?

Speaker: [00:30:05] No, we are pretty much on the same page about that. If one of us wants to go out, we usually manage to get the other excited about it, and we end up enjoying it together. But we are neither extreme party-goers nor homebodies. We balance it out.

Interviewer: [00:30:34] What about movies or shows? Do you have different tastes?

Speaker: [00:30:45] Lately, she has been watching a lot of Korean dramas, which I can't really get into.

Interviewer: [00:30:56] Yes.

Speaker: [00:30:57] I just can't enjoy them.

Interviewer: [00:31:01] It's a common thing now. I haven't gotten into it yet, but I see it coming.

Speaker: [00:31:09] It's becoming more widespread. You can't avoid it. If you look at Netflix now...

Interviewer: [00:31:18] I'm trying to avoid it, but it's hard.

Speaker: [00:31:20] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:31:22] But it's good.

Speaker: [00:31:22] Sometimes she watches it without me. But we've made an agreement that if she watches a movie with me, I'll watch a drama with her.

Interviewer: [00:31:41] That's great. Moving on, how often do these divergences occur?

Speaker: [00:31:57] The most frequent one is about organization. Since we don't live together, I don't see her room often, so it's rare. But it happens, especially when she needs a particular piece of clothing and it's wrinkled.

Interviewer: [00:32:29] How do you resolve such issues?

Speaker: [00:32:40] In those cases, I accept her way. There's no way to force her. It's her upbringing and personality. She's lived this way for [26-30] years, and it's the same at her parents' house. When I lived with my parents, I had my way. It's a matter of how each of us was raised.

Speaker: [00:33:19] Right.

Interviewer: [00:33:27] So, besides these strategies, what other ways do you maintain the relationship?

Speaker: [00:33:54] I like to give her small gifts and surprises. Even though I may not enjoy certain things, I listen to her talk about them because I know it makes her happy. We have a mutual understanding and try to make each other happy.

Interviewer: [00:34:45] Do you think this helps avoid conflicts?

Speaker: [00:34:49] Yes, it prevents arguments and keeps the relationship smooth.

Interviewer: [00:34:50] Would you say your relationship is good for you? Why?

Speaker: [00:35:06] Yes, it is. It makes me happy and has helped me grow as a person. Being in a relationship has improved me, not just romantically but as a person overall.

Interviewer: [00:36:19] You have a shared vision for the future, which is important. It's easier when both are on the same page.

Speaker: [00:36:31] Exactly. We plan things together, and it's easier to achieve our goals as a team. Whether it's traveling or buying a house, we know we can do it together.

Interviewer: [00:37:04] You support each other during tough times.

Speaker: [00:37:10] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:37:12] Has your relationship changed you? How?

Speaker: [00:37:25] Yes, it has made me more mature. I see things differently and have become a better person. The relationship has definitely contributed to that.

Interviewer: [00:38:14] You have different priorities now.

Speaker: [00:38:22] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:38:23] Focusing on your career and future plans rather than partying.



Speaker: [00:38:31] Right. Work takes up most of our day, and we support each other in our professional lives.

Interviewer: [00:38:59] Do you think your girlfriend has also changed because of the relationship?

Speaker: [00:39:05] Yes, definitely. She has also matured. We started young, but we've grown together with the same goals and mindset.

Interviewer: [00:39:44] You've both taken each other's good qualities as examples to improve yourselves.

Speaker: [00:39:53] I believe so.

Speaker: [00:39:57] Excuse me.

Interviewer: [00:40:01] Is your girlfriend the same as she was at the beginning of the relationship? Why or why not?

Speaker: [00:40:14] She has changed. She has matured, just like I have. The relationship has helped her see things differently, handle conflicts better, and react more positively to negative situations.

Interviewer: [00:41:37] She's learned to deal with conflicts and challenges more effectively.

Speaker: [00:41:40] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:41:41] Do you feel secure in your relationship? What makes you feel secure?

Speaker: [00:41:47] Yes, I feel secure. The way she is and acts makes me feel confident. I don't worry about betrayal or anything like that. We trust each other completely.

Interviewer: [00:43:04] Being able to talk about anything openly is key.

Speaker: [00:43:08] Yes, absolutely. She's the person I trust the most. There are things I share with her that I wouldn't even share with my mother or grandmother. We have complete openness.

Speaker: [00:43:56] That's great.

Interviewer: [00:43:58] We are nearing the end of the interview. I'll present some questions with a scale from 1 to 9. You will need to give me a number that reflects your agreement.

Interviewer: [00:44:11] Sure. Let me adjust the screen.

Interviewer: [00:44:24] Here we go. On a scale of 1 to 9, how much do you agree with the statement: "My partner really listens to me."

Speaker: [00:44:41] Eight.

Interviewer: [00:44:53] Next.

Speaker: [00:44:56] Let's go with the next one.

Interviewer: [00:45:07] You can justify your answers if you want.

Speaker: [00:45:11] Sure, I'll justify after responding.

Interviewer: [00:45:16] Next statement: "My partner cares about my needs."

Speaker: [00:45:28] Eight.

Interviewer: [00:45:29] Alright. Let's discuss your ratings.

Speaker: [00:45:41] Regarding the first statement, I chose eight because she listens to me almost all the time. There are moments when it seems like she's not fully engaged, but that's rare. It's usually when she's tired or preoccupied.

Interviewer: [00:46:39] Makes sense. Sometimes we don't feel heard, but we haven't clearly communicated our feelings.

Speaker: [00:46:50] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:46:54] Can you give an example of when you felt truly listened to?

Speaker: [00:47:12] Mainly when I express that I'm not feeling well. She responds and engages in conversation, showing that she's listening and cares. Sometimes, though, we both respond automatically, which is why it's not a nine.

Interviewer: [00:48:29] And about caring for your needs?

Speaker: [00:48:37] It's similar. We both care about each other's needs, but humans can be a bit selfish. When both of us have problems, it's challenging. Usually, one of us has to put aside our issues to support the other, and it's often me who does that.

Interviewer: [00:49:52] I understand. Now, if you feel comfortable, we can proceed with the next questions. You can skip any if you prefer.

Speaker: [00:50:05] Sure.

Interviewer: [00:50:06] Have you been sexually active with your partner recently?

Speaker: [00:50:16] Yes, but not very frequently due to living with family and privacy issues. We both live with our families, so it's tough.

Interviewer: [00:50:39] How satisfied are you with your sex life, and why?

Speaker: [00:51:12] I'm satisfied with her but less so with our privacy and availability. I wish we had more privacy.

Interviewer: [00:51:31] It's hard to have intimacy when family is around.

Speaker: [00:51:38] Exactly. We lack the privacy and intimacy we'd like.

Interviewer: [00:52:01] It can be awkward with family around.

Speaker: [00:52:01] Yes, very much so.

Interviewer: [00:52:30] Now I'll show another scale. How satisfied are you with your relationship overall, considering all aspects?

Speaker: [00:53:03] Overall, I'm very satisfied.

Interviewer: [00:53:29] Why do you evaluate it this way?

Speaker: [00:53:47] Because I can't imagine being happier with anyone else. I don't feel like I'm missing out on anything.

Interviewer: [00:54:13] You don't think about being single or anything like that.

Speaker: [00:54:15] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:54:30] I see. So, your final answer is very satisfied?

Speaker: [00:54:42] Yes, we get along well, and we share the same goals. We support each other, which is crucial.

Interviewer: [00:55:05] People often comment that you look alike, which is usually a good sign.

Speaker: [00:55:28] Yes, we do get that a lot. We complement each other well.

Interviewer: [00:55:32] You've mentioned that.

Speaker: [00:55:36] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:55:36] And your shared goals and support for each other make your relationship strong.

Speaker: [00:56:22] Absolutely. We both want the best for each other and work together to achieve our goals.

Interviewer: [00:56:32] That concludes the questions. Would you like to review your data to see if you want any part of the interview to be revised?

Speaker: [00:56:32] No, you can use it as is.

Interviewer: [00:56:36] Thank you very much. I'll send you a thank-you email and ask if you can refer any other couples who might be interested in participating. You can reply via [Social Media] or email. It's hard to find participants, so any help is appreciated.

Speaker: [00:57:09] Sure, no problem. Just one question about the consent form. How should I sign and send it back?

Interviewer: [00:57:25] You can download it, check the boxes, and send it back via email. You can confirm consent in the email as well.

Speaker: [00:57:47] So, just write a note confirming my consent in the email?

Interviewer: [00:57:52] Yes, exactly. That will work.

Speaker: [00:58:01] Okay, sounds good.

Interviewer: [00:58:03] Thank you very much. Have a good night!

Speaker: [00:58:05] Good night.